



Meeting Transcript: Cohort Strategy, Course Levels & VIP Sessions

Participants

 **Rufat** (Host / Facilitator)

 **Mariana** (Co-organizer / Strategic Advisor)

 **Brian** (Participant / Professional Expert)

Agenda & Topics Discussed

-  **Community Feedback:** Session length, timing (Sunday evenings vs. weekdays), and content difficulty.
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-  **Course Structure:** Moving from unstructured cohorts to clear multi-tiered programs (Associate, Developer, Architect).
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-  **VIP One-on-One Workshops:** Hands-on setup for AI infrastructure, human-in-the-loop systems, and AI security.
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-  **Learning vs. Delivering:** Practical app-building vs. theoretical knowledge.
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Transcript

Section 1: Opening & Session Feedback

 **Rufat:** Hello, Mariana.

 **Mariana:** Hello.

 **Rufat:** Oh, I'm visible. Good. Hello. How are you, Mariana?

 **Mariana:** Good. How are you? Sorry for the audio.

 **Rufat:** That's all right. That's all right. We are alone this week, I guess. Sude is sick and I'm learning about the platform—the school platform—how it does marketing. So what I will do is I added a couple of tasks for myself during the week, every day on LinkedIn. I will make sure that I promote the channel to 30,000 people on my channel. I will also invite people on WhatsApp because these calls are free to join. So that was good. How was your week, Mariana?

 **Mariana:** It's okay. Thank you. I had a meeting with Anna and I sent you feedback. And even now you're talking about events and inviting people. Look, we had a few people that joined us, but they didn't come back.

💬 **Rufat:** Yes, one of them is Sude. Sude said she's sick this week.

💬 **Mariana:** I'm not talking about Sude. I'm talking about all others. Sude and me, we are involved, but for other people, it's complicated. You are trying to run the cohort where people can discuss items freely and enjoy discussion by itself. But they are not on a similar level as you, and they feel very unprofessional. You are feeding them with information that makes them feel that they know more, or as Anna told me, she felt like you are very professional—which is great—but what can she get from it? It was difficult for her to understand everything and to follow the conversation.

💡 **Mariana:** When I ran something similar, we involved people on a similar professional level as a board speaking, and others came to listen. We published a simple agenda and subject ahead of time. In terms of education, people need a program, a clear simple agenda. They want to know what they are going to listen to and do step-by-step. They want to feel smart. Do you remember there were a few people who got scared and didn't come back? Also, Sunday evening is very tricky. It's difficult for people to manage themselves on Sunday evening. And two hours is too much. Make it 30 minutes to one hour. Information overload makes it hard to focus for longer.

💬 **Rufat:** All right. I did get your notes and I want to give feedback on what you said. Anna said it was too complicated, too much information all at once, and Sunday evening was not a good time. Plus, two hours is too much. She suggested trying 5 minutes explaining, 10 minutes Q&A, and three tasks per session.

💬 **Mariana:** Yes, exactly. She was interested in Obsidian and managing science data, but didn't get useful information during the first session.

Section 2: Adjusting Schedules & Structuring Courses

💬 **Rufat:** Oh, we have someone else. Great. Hello, Brian!

💬 **Brian:** Hello. How about now? Can you hear me?

💬 **Rufat:** Now better! Hope you are doing well. I got feedback from Mariana that two hours on Sunday is too long and the content was over people's heads. Mariana suggested moving it to weekdays for one hour. This week I created four courses on the platform: Associate, Developer Foundations, Architect Foundations, and Architect Professional.

💬 **Rufat:** Moving forward, the courses will be separate from these live talks. Live talks will be kept to 1 hour. We'll also have three levels on the platform: Free Tier, Standard Members, and VIP (for 1-on-1 sessions). For VIPs, I selected three subjects for hands-on setup:

1. 🔧 **Environment Setup** (Obsidian, Azure Foundry, RAG)
- 2.

3.  **AI Security**
- 4.
5.  **Human-in-the-Loop (HITL) Workflows**
- 6.

💬 **Brian:** To be honest, I think Sundays are okay, but only if there's a finite timeline—like a 6 or 7-week course—so people know what they are committing to rather than a continuous 2 hours every Sunday. But if we want to attract more people, shorter sessions on weekdays make sense.

💬 **Mariana:** Tuesday or Thursday afternoons around 5:00 PM or 7:00 PM usually work best for working adults. Mondays are too busy and Wednesdays are tricky.

💬 **Rufat:** Brian, what course are you taking right now?

💬 **Brian:** I'm taking a TOGAF (architecture framework) course—4 hours on Saturday and Sunday mornings. It's tough because it's purely governance, which is a completely different mindset from delivery.

💬 **Rufat:** That makes sense. So instead of 2-hour sessions on Sunday, I will offer 1-hour slots during the week and weekend, limiting cohorts to 4–5 people so everyone can participate.

Section 3: Defining Project Levels & 1-on-1 Support

💬 **Brian:** If you want to cover a wide skill level, you should have preset projects:

-  **Foundational Level:** Simple starter projects (e.g., building a clock app).
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-  **Intermediate Level:** Guided execution with core tools.
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-  **Architect / Higher Level:** Complex custom infrastructure.
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💬 **Brian:** That way, people learn the handles and terms before getting hit with architect-level jargon.

💬 **Rufat:** That is brilliant. I will structure the 1-on-1 VIP workshops with preset project levels:

-  **Infrastructure Setup**
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-  **Human-in-the-Loop (HITL)**
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-  **AI Security**
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💬 **Mariana:** Individual 1-on-1 sessions make total sense because people get stuck on individual system problems and don't want to hold up a group.

💬 **Rufat:** Would you commit to two-hour 1-on-1 workshops if they were structured around setting up your specific environment?

💬 **Mariana:** Yes, definitely. Working on my specific problem and subject personally makes a huge difference.

Section 4: Preconditions, Postconditions & The Learning Mindset

💬 **Mariana:** It's very important for people to know what is going to happen and what they can expect:

- 📋 **Preconditions:** What do I need to know or install before attending?
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- 🎯 **Session Goal:** What will I achieve during this hour?
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- 🚀 **Postconditions:** What can I do after the session is finished?
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💬 **Mariana:** If people feel lost or unprepared, the discomfort of uncertainty is so painful that they won't return. They need a step-by-step roadmap to feel confident.

💬 **Brian:** There's also a big difference between a service and a learning opportunity:

- 🛠️ **Service:** "Pay me and I will build it for you."
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- 🏠 **Learning:** "We go through the gears together step-by-step so I learn how to build it myself."
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💬 **Rufat:** I agree. My goal is to help non-technical people build custom apps for free in their own environments without paying for expensive tools—moving people from "riding horses" (manual coding) to "driving cars" (AI-assisted delivery piloting).

Section 5: Final Calendar & Action Items

📌 **Updated Live Calendar Schedule:**

- 📅 **17 Mondays (7:00 PM – 9:00 PM):** VIP 1-on-1 — AI Security Workshop
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- 📅 **17 Tuesdays (7:00 PM – 9:00 PM):** VIP 1-on-1 — Environment Setup
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- 📅 **17 Fridays (7:00 PM – 9:00 PM):** VIP 1-on-1 — Human in the Loop (HITL)
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- 📅 **17 Weekday Cohort Talk:** 1-Hour Lecture / Q&A (Tuesday/Thursday slot)
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💬 **Rufat:** Thank you everyone for joining! I got a lot of great notes today. See you next week!

💬 **Mariana:** Thank you. Bye!

 **Brian:** Thank you, bye-bye.